

■ B.2.4 Formatting Conventions

Good formatting conventions are essential in making *Mathematica* code easy to read. Here are a few suggestions.

- Insert spaces around operators like `+` that have comparatively low precedence.
- Leave spaces after commas and semicolons.
- Break lines so as to keep logically-connected units on the same line.
- Use a separate line for different transformation rules, or different steps in a program.
- Try to use temporary variables to avoid deep nesting of functions.
- Leave spaces in expressions like `f[ g[h[x]] ]` to emphasize outer brackets.
- Indent blocks of code in programs.
- Insert comments when you need to label arguments of functions, such as `f[e, (*variable=*)x]`.

$f @ x$ <code>f[x]</code> $x // f$ <code>f[x]</code> $x \sim f \sim y$ <code>f[x, y]</code>

Alternative input forms for functions.